

Numan

Case Study Presentation

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Part One

Experience translating Product strategy into business impact

Drawing on your own experience, please describe where you were responsible for driving significant business impact through translating product strategy into action and/or transforming the way teams worked to deliver impact.

Part Two

First 90 Days at Numan

Based on what you've learned about Numan so far, outline:

- Your top 3 priorities in your first 90 days
- Why each matters now
- What success would look like by the end of that period

This is not a delivery plan. We want to understand how you bring focus, create alignment, and lay the foundations for lasting impact.

How I reshaped the AI & Chat Org at Cleo to deliver Cleo 3.0

*Experience translating Product strategy into business
impact*

Three teams. No shared vision.

- **QUALITY TEAM**

Measuring at message level, no conversational context, no sense of user journey.

- **ML TEAM**

Building insights and a knowledge graph without a big picture direction for the experience.

- **NOTIFICATIONS**

Succeeding in isolation, but driving one-off engagement, not sustained relationships.

- **THE REAL GAP**

Cleo was more like a goldfish than a financial assistant.

A strategy that mixed product, tech and Cleo's operating model

THE BET

A technical & product 2-year strategy built on Good Strategy / Bad Strategy to build an AI Financial Assistant that helped people progress. That meant: 1) re-architecting from NLP flows to an LLM-native conversational system and 2) shifting teams' remits and ways of working.

WHAT I TRADED OFF

- Worked as player-coach as I identified gaps in the team and started to fill them
- Redefined our success metrics for this project so we could still see progress but focus on big picture
- Moved the successful notification recommender to Growth pillar

I needed proof before getting buy-in.

Worked with the VP of Tech to pull senior engineers into a shadow squad that built an agentic prototype without disrupting live team delivery.

The prototype created leadership conviction.
Without it, re-architecture was a theory.

Defining success

1

CS Contact Rate

[feasibility/viability] Can we add enough tools to avoid flooding our CS team during this big change?

2

Conversion

[viability] Can we keep the business economics healthy?

3

Eval Quality across JTBD

[usability] Does conversational quality improve so that users are getting a better experience?

4

Engagement

[usability] Do LLMs improve user engagement?

Operating Model Changes

1

Vision Artefact

A shared north star the whole team could orient around, not just leadership.

2

Planning & Team Structure

Assumption mapping & opportunity solution trees to map out highest impact areas across our success metrics.

3

New Eval Framework

Shifted from per-message to conversation-level evaluation across 7 dimensions: accuracy, utility, comprehension + more.

4

Shared Roadmap & Gradual Rollout

Cross-team roadmap owned by product & engineering, no more silos so we rolled out features alongside audience rollout.

We broke conversion.

During rollout, we changed the day zero experience and engagement went up but conversion dropped.

Alerting system went off and we investigated.

We isolated the issue. Fixed the experience

Because we had the instrumentation: A/B testing, Growthbook, weekly CEO reporting on four metrics we could move with precision, not fear.

Foundation, not finish line.

5% → 10% → 25% → 50% → 75% → 100%

Hitting parity or better on all four metrics at each rollout gate.

METRIC	BEFORE	AFTER
CS CONTACT RATE	~3%	<1%
CONVERSION	Baseline	Parity maintained
CONV. QUALITY EVAL	~84%	~93%
ENGAGEMENT	Baseline	+2% wk 0

More importantly: The above work means that now Cleo is positioned to move towards an agentic future.

I was too late on shared rhythm.

That's a lesson I'm bringing to Numan.

WHAT I UNDERESTIMATED

Comfort with ambiguity is a founder trait I carry, but not everyone on the team had it.

I underestimated the cognitive load of working in a newly collaborative structure without enough process to hold it together.

WHAT I PUT IN PLACE, LATE

Shared Jira roadmaps, not just high level ones.
Clearer communication rhythms.
Explicit ownership on eng execution & design experience.

RADICAL CANDOR + GROWTH MINDSET

I named the gap early

A team doesn't become high impact if nobody does a diagnosis.

Got into the details: experiential, technical and operational.

OWNERSHIP CULTURE

PM as owners of their domain

Repositioned squads with real remits.
Expected PMs to act like owners.

Moved people who weren't performing;
invested in those who were.

AI LITERACY

AI as default, not a tool

Hosted all-hands and learning sessions.
AI levels the playing field, but only if people feel permission to explore it.

First 90 days at Numan

How I bring focus, create alignment, and lay the foundations for lasting impact.

1

There is a gap between vision & the product execution

Teams are likely executing against condition-specific roadmaps, not a unified north star.

The gap between leadership vision and ground-level execution is what stops velocity.

2

The product reflects the org structure

Weight loss, ED, hair loss, physical experience: built by separate teams, feeling like separate products.

A Human patient today probably doesn't experience a coherent health companion. They experience a series of transactions.

3

The AI opportunity is largely untapped

AI coach with RAG layer in place but models not fine-tuned. No AI-native PMs.

That's not a criticism, it's a window of opportunity that is closing before you fall far behind.

Profitability is an asset. It is not a moat.

THE THREAT

Competitors scaling into Europe, many working with AI-native products. Including Big Tech entering preventive health with distribution advantages.

The window to own holistic health is open, but not indefinitely.

Capitalising on it relies on a cohesive product experience and a world class team to deliver it (quickly).

Diagnose and begin raising the bar.

How you do it

Review work in progress. Sit in on rituals. Read strategy docs and roadmaps. 1:1s with every PM and design lead.

Looking for ownership instinct, quality of thinking, how people handle ambiguity, and whether they're orienting toward outcomes or outputs.

By day 30: clear view of who's performing, who has potential, who's in the wrong seat, and what's missing.

Net new roles

Start hiring immediately. AI-native PM thinking is the first priority hire.

Existing team

Don't move people before you've given them clarity. The operating model change comes in parallel to this.

Build the operating model that connects vision to execution.

By day 60: reworked operating model, planning cadence that ladders up to a north star for the company.

1

Vision + Translation

A vision artefact that converts the north star into something teams make **daily decisions** against.

3

New Rituals & Cadence

Weekly and monthly rituals that create alignment **beyond product, into ops + clinical to unify the patient journey.**

2

Planning & shared goal framework

OKR planning with clear ownership at squad level. Teams know exactly what they're responsible for and how it ladders up.
An operational bridge to the strategy.

4

Performance Standards

A **standard** for strategy docs, roadmaps, product reviews and a performance framework that includes AI fluency

Define the AI opportunity and begin sequencing it.

In the Product

Right now Numan patients experience isolated condition journeys. The unlock is an AI health companion that connects weight management, sexual health, testosterone, and diagnostics into a coherent longitudinal relationship.

That's not a feature. That's a product paradigm shift. And it's what makes Numan defensible. We need the (safe) AI roadmap to implement it.

Internally

Any team that doesn't unlock AI ways of working will be outpaced.

AI-native PMs, faster experimentation cycles, using AI to compress the distance between insight and decision.

By day 90: Start with digital experience and internal capability. Clinical ops integration comes once the connective tissue is in place. By day 90 we have an AI strategy and at least one AI-native PM hired.

How we know it's working.

**The one leading indicator
I'd watch above everything:**

Are teams making better decisions faster, with less escalation? That's the signal that the middle layer is working.

01 Team Gaps and Hiring Plan

We know the gaps and are actively hiring to fill them

02 Operating model live

Teams have OKRs, a shared cadence, and a vision artefact their goals actually ladder up to

03 AI strategy shared

Internal capability unlocked and we've moved onto building AI into a unified product experience.

How it all comes together

The Cleo chapter

Three teams, no shared vision, no north star.

A rearchitecture with improved metrics and a foundation that kept delivering after I built it.

The Numan parallel

Different context, structurally similar: a gap between vision and execution, an AI opportunity not yet being seized, a product team not yet held to the standard the moment demands.

Why I'm here

I'm not here to tell you what you want to hear.

This is one of the most interesting product problems in health tech right now. I want to be the person who solves it.